8.10.1 Types of Fabric Spreading

The spreads can be of two basic types :

- **Flat Spreads**

All piles are of the same length.

- **Stepped Spreads**

As the name suggests, the spread is built up in steps, with all the plies in one step having the same length. A stepped spread is generally used when the quantities to be cut is more. According to the order plan details the cut number, colour and ply length is done for stepped spread method.

8.10.2 Requirement of Spreading Process

- Alignment of plies in both length and width direction.
- Elimination of fabric defects/flaws.
- Correct ply direction (especially for asymmetrical printed fabric) all face up, all face down, face to face etc.
- Correct ply tension- ply tension must be uniform and as much as possible.
- Avoidance of distortion in the spread during cutting.
- Fabric must be flat and free from any wrinkle and crease.
- Checks and stripes should be matched.

8.11 Laying The Patterns

A fabric has to be prepared well it should be pre-shrunk and ironed before the patterns are placed on it. The fabric has to be spread neatly on a clean large table. One can even use a clean floor. Remember to use a surface bigger than fabric, so that overlapping of the fabric or mismarking can be avoided.

Different Types of Layout

Layout has to follow a specific pattern, which mainly depends upon the type of the garment, the pattern pieces and the width of the fabric. The different types of fabric layout namely lengthwise centre fold, off centre lengthwise fold, cross wise centre fold, off centre cross wise fold, combination fold and open layout.

8.11.1 Pattern Laying of Special Fabric

Pattern laying need extra care when the fabric vary like knits or silk.

8.11.1.1 Knits

The inter looping of a single yarn is known as knitted fabric. There are various varieties of knitted fabrics like single and double jersey, tricot and rib. Jersey fabrics are mostly used for garment construction.

- Pulling or tearing should be avoided to straighten the fabric.
- Lay the folded edges straight on a flat surface or cutting table.
- Fold the fabric at right angles and cut from selvedge.
- Mark the outline of the patterns using a tailor's chalk or red and blue pencil.
- Open layout is best for jersey fabrics irrespective of the type of the garment.

8.11.1.2 Silk

These fabrics are very thin, slippery and delicate. Great care is required in marking and cutting these fabrics. Pre shrinking is not required for silk fabrics. They can be used directly as purchased from the shops.

To straighten the fabric, lay them on the table and pull in cross wise direction. Lay the fabric on the flat smooth surface. Move fingers smoothly over the fabric to remove creases.

Place the pattern on the right side of the fabric. Right side can be identified

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